VERSION 2 · 6 DAYS · UPPER-BODY FOCUS · LEFT-ELBOW SAFE

UPPER-BODY PUMP PLAN

Lean muscle with the focus on chest, back, shoulders and arms, plus abs and fat loss. Built around a left-elbow surgery: machines, cables and neutral grips. Pick today's day, follow the cards, tap a circle after each set.

Download PDF | Version 1: Recomp plan

THIS WEEK

Mon	**Chest & Triceps**	60–70 min
Tue	**Back & Biceps**	60–70 min
Wed	**Legs & Abs**	55–65 min
Thu	**Shoulders & Arms**	60–70 min
Fri	**Chest & Back Pump**	60–70 min
Sat	**Delts, Arms & Abs**	50–60 min
Sun	**Rest & Elbow Care**	15–20 min, optional

Tap any **Watch video** link in this PDF to open a form tutorial on YouTube. Tick the circles with a pen, or use the phone version to track sets and rest.

MON

CHEST & TRICEPS

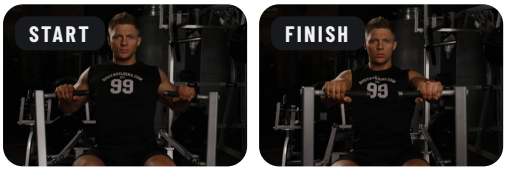
60–70 min | 25 working sets | 8 exercises

Warm-up 10 min | Weights 40–45 min | Abs 8 min | Cardio 15 min

WARM-UP · 8-10 MIN

1. 5 min easy rower or bike to get warm
2. Wrist circles ×10 each way, then make a fist and open ×10
3. Forearm rotations ×15: hold a light dumbbell by one end, turn palm up, palm down (left arm first)
4. Light band curls ×20 and light band pushdowns ×20, slow and pain-free
5. Band pull-aparts ×15
6. Ramp-up sets on your first exercise: 40% ×15, 60% ×10, 80% ×5

MAIN LIFTS



Machine Chest Press

4 × 8–12
rest 1:30 min
tempo 3-0-1-1

1. Set the seat so the handles line up with mid-chest
2. Lower for 3 seconds until you feel a stretch across the chest
3. Press without locking the elbows hard, squeeze for 1 second

Avoid: Slamming the stack or bouncing out of the bottom

Left elbow: Use the neutral (palms facing) handles if the machine has them. Stop just short of full lockout.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3 4

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Neutral-grip dumbbell press · Smith machine bench press · Flat dumbbell fly



Incline Dumbbell Press

3 × 10–12
rest 1:30 min
tempo 3-1-1-0

Turn your palms to face each other (neutral grip) for your elbow.

1. Bench at 30°, palms facing each other or slightly turned in
2. Lower to the upper chest and pause 1 second in the stretch
3. Press up and slightly together

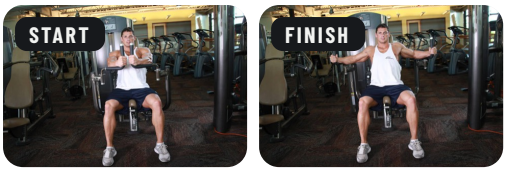
Avoid: Bench too steep, flaring elbows straight out

Left elbow: Neutral grip takes most of the strain off the elbow. If the left arm tires first, end the set there for both arms.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Incline machine press · Incline Smith machine press · Low-to-high cable fly



Pec Deck Fly

3 × 12–15
rest 1 min
tempo 2-0-1-2

1. Elbows slightly bent and fixed, like hugging a tree
2. Bring the handles together and squeeze hard for 2 seconds
3. Open slowly until you feel a chest stretch

Avoid: Opening so far that your shoulders feel pulled

Left elbow: Keep the elbow angle locked; the shoulder does the work, not the elbow. Last set: drop the weight 30% and keep going.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Cable chest fly · Flat dumbbell fly · Machine chest press, light



Low-to-High Cable Fly

3 × 15
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-1

1. Cables at the lowest setting, step forward
2. Sweep hands up and together to chin height
3. Squeeze the upper chest at the top

Avoid: Turning it into a front raise with straight arms

Left elbow: Light weight, soft elbow. Great pump with almost no elbow stress.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Incline dumbbell fly · Incline machine press · Pec deck, seat raised



Single-Arm Cable Pushdown

3 × 12–15 /side
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-1

Photo shows the two-handed version; use one handle and one arm.

1. Stand side-on, elbow pinned to your side
2. Push down until the arm is straight, squeeze for 1 second
3. Let it rise only to 90°

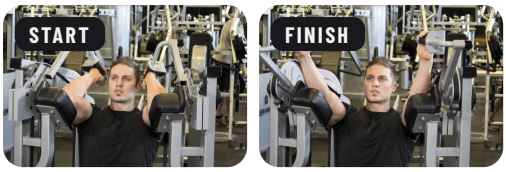
Avoid: Leaning your body over the handle

Left elbow: Start with the left arm, pick a weight it handles pain-free, then match it with the right.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Rope pushdown, light · V-bar pushdown · Machine triceps extension



Machine Triceps Extension

3 × 12–15
rest 1 min
tempo 2-0-1-1

1. Elbows on the pad, back flat
2. Extend smoothly to almost straight
3. Return slowly to about 90°

Avoid: Jerking the weight from the bottom

Left elbow: If the deep bend at the start feels sharp, start the rep from a little further out.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Rope pushdown · Straight-bar pushdown · Single-arm cable pushdown

ABS & OBLIQUES



Decline Crunch

3 × 15
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-1

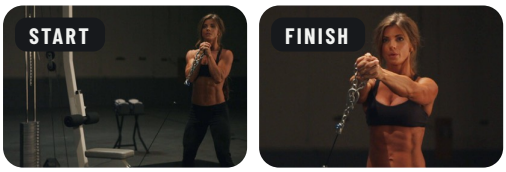
1. Feet hooked, hands across chest
2. Curl your ribs toward your hips, not just your head forward
3. Lower slowly

Avoid: Pulling on your neck

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Cable crunch · Ab crunch machine · Weighted crunch



Pallof Press

3 × 12 /side
rest 45 s
tempo hold 2 s

1. Stand side-on to a cable at chest height
2. Press the handle straight out and hold 2 seconds
3. Don't let the cable twist you

Avoid: Rotating your hips toward the cable

Left elbow: Light weight; this is an oblique exercise, the arms just hold.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Band Pallof press · Side plank · Cable woodchop, light

CARDIO · FINISH HERE

Incline treadmill walk or stair climber, 15 min, steady pace you can talk at.

TUE

BACK & BICEPS

60–70 min | 28 working sets | 9 exercises

Warm-up 10 min | Weights 40–45 min | Abs 8 min | Cardio 15 min

WARM-UP · 8–10 MIN

1. 5 min easy rower or bike to get warm
2. Wrist circles ×10 each way, then make a fist and open ×10
3. Forearm rotations ×15: hold a light dumbbell by one end, turn palm up, palm down (left arm first)
4. Light band curls ×20 and light band pushdowns ×20, slow and pain-free
5. Band pull-aparts ×15
6. Ramp-up sets on your first exercise: 40% ×15, 60% ×10, 80% ×5

MAIN LIFTS



Machine High Row

4 × 10–12
rest 1:30 min
tempo 2-0-1-2

1. Chest against the pad, grab the handles
2. Drive elbows down and back, squeeze the lats for 2 seconds
3. Let the arms rise fully for a stretch

Avoid: Shrugging the shoulders up to your ears

Left elbow: Use a strap or lighter weight if the left grip or elbow gives out first.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3 4

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Lat pulldown, neutral grip · Assisted pull-up machine · One-arm lat pulldown



Chest-Supported T-Bar Row

4 × 8–12
rest 1:30 min
tempo 2-0-1-1

1. Chest on the pad, neutral handles
2. Pull to the lower chest, squeezing shoulder blades together
3. Lower all the way for a full stretch

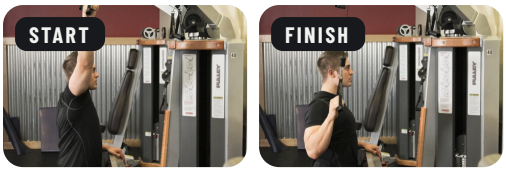
Avoid: Lifting your chest off the pad to cheat the weight up

Left elbow: The pad takes your lower back out of it so you can focus on the squeeze, not the load.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3 4

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Chest-supported dumbbell row · Machine row · Seated cable row, neutral grip



One-Arm Lat Pulldown

3 × 12 /side
rest 1 min
tempo 2-0-1-1

1. Kneel or sit under a high cable, one handle
2. Pull elbow down to your side, slightly behind you
3. Reach all the way up for the stretch

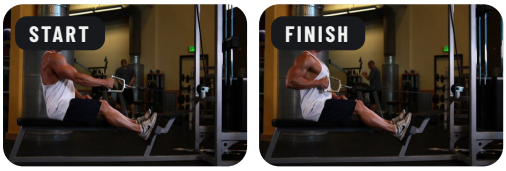
Avoid: Twisting your torso to finish the rep

Left elbow: One arm at a time lets the left side go lighter without holding the right side back.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Lat pulldown, neutral grip · Machine high row · Straight-arm cable pulldown



Seated One-Arm Cable Row

3 × 12 /side
rest 1 min
tempo 2-0-1-2

1. Sit tall, one handle at a time
2. Row to your hip, elbow close to the body
3. Let the shoulder reach forward for a stretch

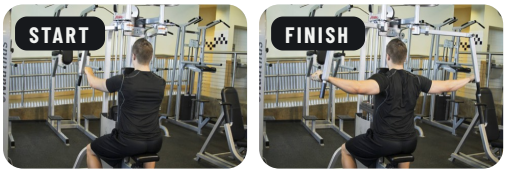
Avoid: Rocking back with the whole torso

Left elbow: Don't let the left elbow snap straight at the front; keep it soft.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Chest-supported machine row · One-arm dumbbell row · Seated cable row



Reverse Machine Fly

3 × 15
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-2

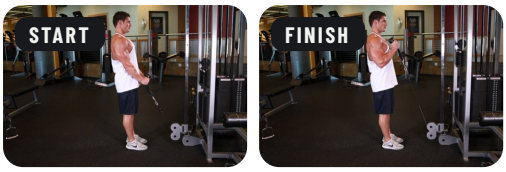
1. Face the pad, arms out at shoulder height
2. Sweep back until your arms are in line with your body
3. Squeeze the rear delts for 2 seconds

Avoid: Going heavy and swinging

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Cable rear delt fly · Bent-over dumbbell rear fly · Face pull



Cable Rope Hammer Curl

3 × 12–15
rest 1 min
tempo 2-0-1-2

1. Rope on the low cable, palms facing each other
2. Curl up keeping elbows at your sides
3. Squeeze for 2 seconds, then lower for 2

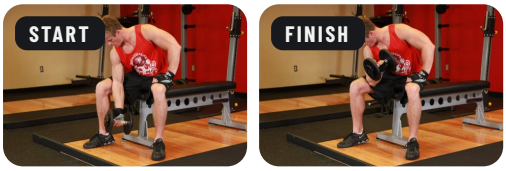
Avoid: Elbows drifting forward

Left elbow: Neutral (hammer) grip is the most elbow-friendly curl. This is your main biceps exercise.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Dumbbell hammer curl · Cross-body hammer curl · Cable curl



Concentration Curl

2 × 12–15 /side
rest 45 s
tempo 3-0-1-1

1. Sit, elbow braced on your inner thigh
2. Curl up and squeeze hard at the top
3. Lower for 3 seconds, stop just short of fully straight

Avoid: Swinging the shoulder to lift

Left elbow: Left arm first, lighter. Never let the dumbbell drop into a straight elbow.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Cable curl · Machine preacher curl, light · Incline dumbbell curl

ABS & OBLIQUES



Captain's Chair Knee Raise

3 × 12–15
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-1

1. Forearms on the pads, back against the rest
2. Lift knees up and curl the pelvis toward you
3. Lower slowly, don't swing

Avoid: Swinging the legs with momentum

Left elbow: Your forearms support you on the pads, so there's no hanging strain on the elbow.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Lying leg raise · Reverse crunch · Decline bench reverse crunch



Leg Pull-In

3 × 15
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-1

1. Sit on the edge of a bench, lean back slightly
2. Pull knees toward your chest
3. Extend legs out without touching the floor

Avoid: Rounding your shoulders forward

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Reverse crunch · Flat bench leg raise · Dead bug

CARDIO · FINISH HERE

Incline treadmill walk, 15 min. Incline 8–12%, speed 4.5–5.5 km/h.

WED

LEGS & ABS

55–65 min · 23 working sets · 7 exercises

Warm-up 10 min · Weights 35–40 min · Abs 8 min · Cardio 10 min

WARM-UP · 8–10 MIN

1. 5 min easy bike or treadmill
2. Bodyweight squats ×15
3. Leg swings ×10 each leg, front-back and side-side
4. Glute bridges ×15
5. Ramp-up sets on your first exercise: 40% ×15, 60% ×10, 80% ×5

MAIN LIFTS



Hack Squat

4 × 8–12
rest 2 min
tempo 3-0-1-0

1. Shoulders under the pads, feet shoulder-width
2. Lower for 3 seconds to at least parallel
3. Drive up through the whole foot

Avoid: Knees caving in, heels lifting

Left elbow: No barbell to hold, so your elbows stay out of it. Better choice than back squats for your arm.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3 4

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Leg press · Smith machine squat · Goblet squat



Barbell Hip Thrust

3 × 10–12
rest 1:30 min
tempo 2-0-1-2

1. Upper back on a bench, bar padded over the hips
2. Drive hips up until your body is flat, squeeze glutes 2 seconds
3. Lower under control

Avoid: Arching the lower back at the top

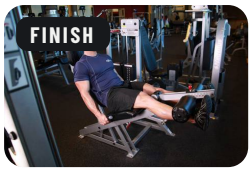
Left elbow: Hands only steady the bar; they don't carry weight.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Glute bridge machine · Smith machine hip thrust · Dumbbell hip thrust





Leg Extension

3 × 15
rest 1 min
tempo 2-0-1-2

1. Pad just above the ankles
2. Kick up and squeeze the quads hard for 2 seconds
3. Lower slowly

Avoid: Swinging the weight up

Left elbow: Last set: drop the weight 30% and go again.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Sissy squat, assisted · Leg press, feet low · Goblet squat, heels raised





Seated Leg Curl

3 × 12–15
rest 1 min
tempo 2-0-1-2

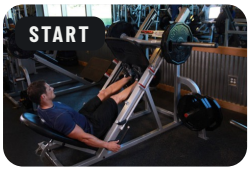
1. Lock your thighs under the pad
2. Curl heels down and back, squeeze 2 seconds
3. Return slowly

Avoid: Lifting hips off the seat

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Lying leg curl · Standing leg curl · Stability-ball leg curl





Calf Press on Leg Press

4 × 15–20
rest 45 s
tempo 2-2-1-1

1. Balls of feet on the bottom edge of the platform
2. Lower heels for a 2-second stretch, pause
3. Press up high and squeeze

Avoid: Bouncing through short reps

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3 4

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Standing calf raise · Seated calf raise · Smith machine calf raise

ABS & OBLIQUES



Weighted Crunch

3 × 15
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-1

1. Hold a plate on your chest
2. Curl your ribs toward your hips
3. Lower slowly

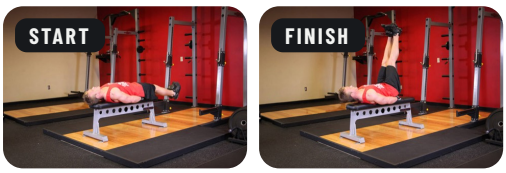
Avoid: Pulling with your neck

Left elbow: Hold the plate against your chest with both hands, elbows tucked; no strain.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Cable crunch · Ab crunch machine · Decline crunch



Flat Bench Leg Raise

3 × 15
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-1

1. Lie on a bench, hold the sides behind your head
2. Raise straight legs to vertical
3. Lower until just above the bench

Avoid: Lower back arching off the bench

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Reverse crunch · Captain's chair knee raise · Dead bug

CARDIO · FINISH HERE

Easy bike, 10 min.

THU

SHOULDERS & ARMS

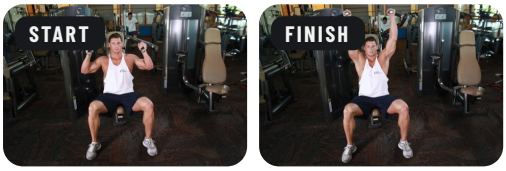
60–70 min | 22 working sets | 7 exercises

Warm-up 10 min | Weights 40–45 min | Abs 6 min | Cardio 15 min

WARM-UP · 8-10 MIN

1. 5 min easy rower or bike to get warm
2. Wrist circles ×10 each way, then make a fist and open ×10
3. Forearm rotations ×15: hold a light dumbbell by one end, turn palm up, palm down (left arm first)
4. Light band curls ×20 and light band pushdowns ×20, slow and pain-free
5. Band pull-aparts ×15
6. Ramp-up sets on your first exercise: 40% ×15, 60% ×10, 80% ×5

MAIN LIFTS



Machine Shoulder Press

4 × 8–12
rest 1:30 min
tempo 3-0-1-0

1. Seat set so handles start at shoulder height
2. Press up without fully locking out
3. Lower for 3 seconds

Avoid: Arching your back off the pad

Left elbow: Neutral handles if possible. Stop 2–3 cm short of lockout to keep tension on the delts and off the elbow.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3 4

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Smith machine seated press · Neutral-grip dumbbell press · Landmine press



Dumbbell Lateral Raise

4 × 12–15
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-1

1. Slight bend in the elbows, locked in place
2. Raise out to the side to shoulder height, leading with the elbows
3. Lower for 2 seconds

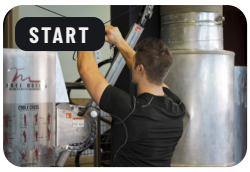
Avoid: Swinging or shrugging

Left elbow: Light weight and a fixed elbow, so very little joint stress. Last set: myo-reps (rest 5 breaths, 4–5 more reps, repeat 3 times).

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3 4

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Cable lateral raise · Lateral raise machine · Band lateral raise





Cable Rear Delt Fly

3 × 15
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-2

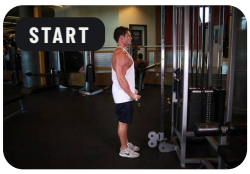
1. Cables at shoulder height, cross them over
2. Pull back and out until arms are in line with your shoulders
3. Squeeze 2 seconds

Avoid: Turning it into a row by bending the elbows

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Reverse machine fly · Face pull · Bent-over dumbbell rear fly





Standing Cable Curl

3 × 12–15
rest 1 min
tempo 2-0-1-2

1. Straight or EZ handle on a low cable
2. Curl up, elbows pinned
3. Lower for 2 seconds, stop just short of straight

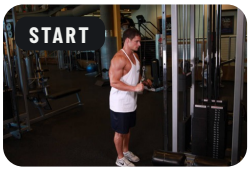
Avoid: Leaning back to finish reps

Left elbow: If a palms-up grip hurts the left elbow, swap to the rope hammer version.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Cable rope hammer curl · Dumbbell hammer curl · Machine preacher curl, light





V-Bar Pushdown

3 × 12–15
rest 1 min
tempo 2-0-1-1

1. Elbows at your sides
2. Push down to straight arms, squeeze
3. Let it rise to just past 90°

Avoid: Elbows flaring out or moving forward

Left elbow: Swap for the rope if the V-bar angle feels off on the left side.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Rope pushdown · Single-arm cable pushdown · Machine triceps extension



Cross-Body Hammer Curl

2 × 12 /side
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-1

1. Curl the dumbbell across your body toward the opposite chest
2. Squeeze at the top
3. Lower slowly

Avoid: Swinging the shoulder

Left elbow: Neutral grip, left arm first.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Cable rope hammer curl · Dumbbell hammer curl · Concentration curl

ABS & OBLIQUES

Cable Woodchop

3 × 12 /side
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-1

1. Cable at shoulder height, stand side-on
2. Rotate through your torso to pull the handle down and across
3. Control it back

Avoid: Pulling with the arms instead of turning the torso

Left elbow: Light weight, arms stay fairly straight; your obliques do the work.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Pallof press · Russian twist · Side plank

CARDIO · FINISH HERE

Incline treadmill walk or stair climber, 15 min.

FRI

CHEST & BACK PUMP

60–70 min | 23 working sets | 7 exercises

Warm-up 10 min | Weights 40–45 min | Abs 6 min | Cardio 15 min

WARM-UP · 8–10 MIN

1. 5 min easy rower or bike to get warm
2. Wrist circles ×10 each way, then make a fist and open ×10
3. Forearm rotations ×15: hold a light dumbbell by one end, turn palm up, palm down (left arm first)
4. Light band curls ×20 and light band pushdowns ×20, slow and pain-free
5. Band pull-aparts ×15
6. Ramp-up sets on your first exercise: 40% ×15, 60% ×10, 80% ×5

MAIN LIFTS



Smith Machine Incline Press

4 × 8–10
rest 1:30 min
tempo 3-1-1-0

1. Bench at 30°, bar lines up with the upper chest
2. Lower for 3 seconds, 1-second pause just above the chest
3. Press up without locking out hard

Avoid: Bench too steep, bouncing the bar

Left elbow: Slightly narrower than normal grip but not close-grip. If the left elbow complains, switch to neutral-grip dumbbells.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3 4

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Incline dumbbell press, neutral grip · Incline machine press · Low-to-high cable fly



Lat Pulldown, Neutral Grip

4 × 10–12
rest 1:30 min
tempo 2-0-1-2

Photo shows a wide bar; swap it for the V-handle or parallel-grip bar.

1. Use the V-handle or parallel-grip bar
2. Pull to the upper chest, squeeze the lats
3. Let the arms rise fully

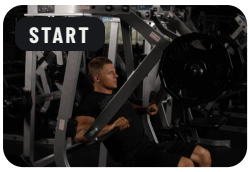
Avoid: Leaning far back

Left elbow: Neutral grip is easier on the elbow than a wide overhand bar.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3 4

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Machine high row · One-arm lat pulldown · Assisted pull-up machine





Decline Machine Press

3 × 10–12
rest 1 min
tempo 2-0-1-1

1. Handles at lower chest
2. Press out and squeeze
3. Return slowly

Avoid: Locking out hard

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Cable crossover, high-to-low · Machine chest press · Dumbbell bench press, neutral grip





Chest-Supported Dumbbell Row

3 × 10–12
rest 1 min
tempo 2-0-1-2

1. Lie face down on a 30° bench
2. Row the dumbbells to your hips
3. Squeeze shoulder blades 2 seconds

Avoid: Lifting your chest off the bench

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Chest-supported T-bar row · Machine row · Seated one-arm cable row





Cable Crossover

3 × 15
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-2

1. Cables high, step forward
2. Bring hands together in front of your belly button
3. Squeeze 2 seconds, open slowly

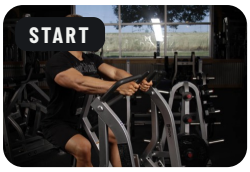
Avoid: Pressing instead of flying

Left elbow: Elbows soft and fixed. Last set: drop set.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Pec deck fly · Low-to-high cable fly · Flat dumbbell fly





Machine Iso Row

3 × 12–15 /side
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-2

Do one arm at a time.

1. One arm at a time, chest on the pad
2. Row back until your elbow passes your body
3. Squeeze, then reach forward for a stretch

Avoid: Twisting off the pad

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Seated one-arm cable row · One-arm dumbbell row · Machine high row

ABS & OBLIQUES





Decline Reverse Crunch

3 × 15
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-1

1. Head at the top of a decline bench, hold the bench
2. Curl knees to chest and lift the hips
3. Lower slowly

Avoid: Swinging the legs

Left elbow: Grip lightly with the left hand; you're not hanging.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Reverse crunch · Captain's chair knee raise · Leg pull-in

CARDIO · FINISH HERE

Incline treadmill walk, 15 min.

SAT

DELTS, ARMS & ABS

50–60 min | 24 working sets | 8 exercises

Warm-up 10 min | Weights 30–35 min | Abs 10 min | Cardio 10 min

WARM-UP · 8–10 MIN

1. 5 min easy rower or bike to get warm
2. Wrist circles ×10 each way, then make a fist and open ×10
3. Forearm rotations ×15: hold a light dumbbell by one end, turn palm up, palm down (left arm first)
4. Light band curls ×20 and light band pushdowns ×20, slow and pain-free
5. Band pull-aparts ×15
6. Ramp-up sets on your first exercise: 40% ×15, 60% ×10, 80% ×5

MAIN LIFTS



Neutral-Grip Dumbbell Shoulder Press

3 × 10–12
rest 1:30 min
tempo 3-0-1-0

Photo shows palms forward; turn them to face each other.

1. Bench almost upright, palms facing each other
2. Press up and slightly in
3. Lower to ear level

Avoid: Arching your back

Left elbow: Neutral grip is the elbow-friendly version of the press.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Machine shoulder press · Landmine press · Smith machine seated press



Band Lateral Raise

3 × 20
rest 30 s
tempo 1-0-1-1

1. Stand on a band, hold the ends
2. Raise out to shoulder height
3. Lower with control

Avoid: Shrugging

Left elbow: High reps, short rest: this one is for the pump.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Dumbbell lateral raise · Cable lateral raise · Lateral raise machine





Reverse Dumbbell Fly

3 × 15
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-2

1. Hinge forward, chest close to your thighs or on an incline bench
2. Raise dumbbells out to the sides
3. Squeeze the rear delts

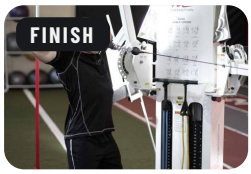
Avoid: Using momentum

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Cable rear delt fly · Reverse machine fly · Face pull





Face Pull

3 × 15
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-2

1. Rope at eye level
2. Pull toward your face, hands by your ears
3. Thumbs point back at the end

Avoid: Going heavy

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Band face pull · Reverse machine fly · Cable rear delt fly





Dumbbell Hammer Curl

3 × 12
rest 1 min
tempo 2-0-1-2

1. Palms facing each other
2. Curl to shoulder height, squeeze
3. Lower for 2 seconds

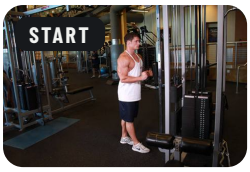
Avoid: Elbows moving forward

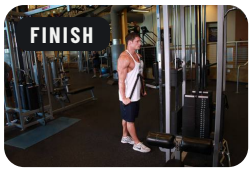
Left elbow: Alternate arms and start with the left.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Cable rope hammer curl · Cross-body hammer curl · Cable curl





Rope Pushdown

3 × 15
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-2

1. Elbows pinned
2. Push down and spread the rope at the bottom
3. Squeeze 2 seconds

Avoid: Leaning your weight into it

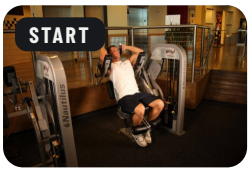
Left elbow: Finish biceps and triceps with one light drop set each if the elbow feels fine.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): V-bar pushdown · Single-arm cable pushdown · Machine triceps extension

ABS & OBLIQUES





Ab Crunch Machine

3 × 15
rest 45 s
tempo 2-0-1-2

1. Set the seat so the pads sit on your chest
2. Crunch down by curling the ribs to the hips
3. Return slowly

Avoid: Pulling with your arms

Left elbow: Let your torso do the work; the arms only hold.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Cable crunch · Weighted crunch · Decline crunch

Russian Twist

3 × 20 total
rest 45 s
tempo controlled

1. Sit, lean back slightly, feet on or off the floor
2. Rotate your shoulders side to side
3. Hold a light plate only if it's easy

Avoid: Moving only the arms, not the torso

Left elbow: Hold the weight close to your chest with elbows bent and relaxed.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2 3

Machine busy? Swap for (tap a name for its video): Cable woodchop · Pallof press · Side plank

CARDIO · FINISH HERE

Easy bike or brisk walk, 10 min.

SUN

REST & ELBOW CARE

15–20 min, optional

ELBOW & MOBILITY ROUTINE

Wrist Flexor Stretch

2 × 30 s /arm

1. Arm straight in front, palm up
2. Gently pull the fingers back with the other hand
3. Feel it in the inner forearm

Avoid: Forcing it into pain

Left elbow: Do the left arm gently and only as far as is comfortable.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2

Or try (tap a name for its video): Prayer stretch · Wall forearm stretch

Wrist Extensor Stretch

2 × 30 s /arm

1. Arm straight, palm down
2. Gently press the back of the hand down
3. Feel it on top of the forearm

Avoid: Bouncing

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2

Or try (tap a name for its video): Reverse prayer stretch · Wall forearm stretch

Forearm Rotations

2 × 15 /arm

tempo slow

1. Hold a light dumbbell or hammer by one end, elbow at your side bent 90°
2. Turn palm up, then palm down, slowly
3. Keep the elbow still

Avoid: Using a heavy weight

Left elbow: Good for elbow range of motion after surgery. Stop if sharp pain.

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2

Or try (tap a name for its video): Rotations with no weight · Band rotations





Stick Chest & Shoulder Stretch

2 × 10 slow reps

1. Hold a broomstick or band with a wide grip
2. Keep arms straight, lift overhead then back as far as is comfortable
3. Widen your grip if it feels tight

Avoid: Bending the elbows or forcing past a pinch

▶ Watch how ▸

1 2

Or try (tap a name for its video): Doorway chest stretch · Wall shoulder slides





Child's Pose

1 × 60 s

1. Knees wide, sit back toward heels
2. Arms stretched forward
3. Breathe into your back

▶ Watch how ▸

1

Or try (tap a name for its video): Puppy pose · Lying knees-to-chest hug

ACTIVITY

Walk 8,000–10,000 steps. Total rest is fine too; muscle is built while you recover.

READ ONCE, THEN CHECK WEEKLY

HOW VERSION 2 WORKS

The week

DAY	SESSION	CARDIO
Mon	Chest & Triceps	15 min incline walk
Tue	Back & Biceps	15 min incline walk
Wed	Legs & Abs	10 min easy bike
Thu	Shoulders & Arms	15 min incline walk
Fri	Chest & Back Pump	15 min incline walk
Sat	Delts, Arms & Abs	10 min easy bike
Sun	Rest & Elbow Care	8–10k steps

Upper body is trained 5 days a week: chest, back and shoulders twice each, arms three times, legs once. That's where the extra growth will show. Every session also has abs work and a short cardio finish to bring belly fat down.

How to get the pump

- **Tempo** is written as 4 numbers, e.g. **3-0-1-1**: 3 seconds lowering, 0 pause at the bottom, 1 second lifting, 1 second squeeze at the top. Slow lowering = more growth.
- **Rest short:** 45–90 seconds on most exercises. Use the rest timer on each card.
- **Last set intensifiers:** where a card says *drop set* (drop weight 30%, keep going) or *myo-reps* (rest 5 breaths, 4–5 more reps, three times). Only on machines and cables, never on free-weight presses.
- **Feel the muscle:** if you can't feel the target muscle working, the weight is too heavy.
- **Before training:** carbs and water 60–90 min before (banana, rice, oats) make a much bigger pump than any pre-workout.

Left elbow rules

> **Get clearance from your surgeon or physio before lifting heavy.** Show them this plan. If they give you limits (range of motion, weight, timeline), their advice comes first.

- **Pain rule:** mild discomfort up to 3 out of 10 that's gone by the next morning is OK. Sharp pain, pain that builds during a set, or pain the next day means stop that exercise and use a swap.
- **Left arm leads:** on one-arm exercises, do the left arm first, pick a weight it handles cleanly, then match the right arm to it.
- **Avoid for now:** skull crushers, dips, close-grip bench press, heavy straight-bar curls, heavy barbell pressing to hard lockout, behind-the-head extensions.
- **Prefer:** neutral (palms-facing) grips, machines and cables, stopping just short of full lockout, slow lowering.
- **Warm the elbow every session** with the forearm rotations and light band curls/pushdowns in the warm-up.
- **See a doctor** if you get swelling, a locking/catching feeling, loss of movement, or tingling/numbness in the ring and little fingers.

About belly fat and abs

> Ab exercises build the muscle underneath; the fat on top comes off only when your whole body fat drops. That's why the food targets, daily steps and cardio matter as much as the crunches. Measure your waist weekly: if your weight goes up but your waist stays the same or drops, you're building muscle, not fat.

12-week progression

WEEKS	PHASE	WHAT TO DO
1–2	Groove	Pick weights you could do 3 more reps with. Learn the tempo and find which swaps feel best on the left elbow.
3–6	Build	Stop sets 1–2 reps before failure. Add reps first, then weight (rule below). Start using drop sets and myo-reps.
7	Deload	Same exercises, half the sets, 10–15% lighter. Joints and tendons catch up.
8–11	Push	Add 1 set per week to chest, back or shoulders, whichever is lagging (max +3 sets each). Keep the elbow pain rule.
12	Deload & check	Light week, new photos and measurements, then restart at week 3 with your new weights.

Rule for adding weight: when you hit the top of the rep range (e.g. 12 of 8–12) on every set with clean tempo, go up next session: the next dumbbell, the next pin on machines, or 2.5 kg on bars. **Arms and the left side go up slowest.** Muscles can grow faster than tendons, especially on a cycle, so don't jump weights.

Your daily targets

Body weight (kg)

75

2250–2400
calories / day

150–165 g
protein / day

68 g
fat / day

~270 g
carbs / day

3.0 L
water / day

Lean bulk with fat loss means eating close to maintenance with lots of protein, not a big surplus. Check every 2 weeks: if weight is up more than 1 kg and waist is up, cut 200 calories (from carbs). If weight and waist haven't moved, add 150–200 calories.

Food

Every meal: **a palm-to-fist of protein**, a fist of carbs (rice, roti, oats, potato), vegetables, and a thumb of fat. Most of your carbs go in the meals before and after training.

MEAL	NON-VEG	VEGETARIAN
Breakfast	4 egg whites + 2 whole eggs, 60 g oats with milk, fruit	Paneer bhurji (150 g) + 2 roti, fruit
Lunch	200 g chicken, 1 cup rice, dal, salad	Soya chunk curry (60 g dry), 1 cup rice, dal, salad
Pre-workout (60–90 min before)	2 bananas or 2 slices bread with peanut butter, plus water	
Post-workout	250 g hung curd + fruit, or whey if you use it	250 g hung curd + fruit, or whey if you use it
Dinner	200 g fish or chicken, 2 roti, sabzi	Tofu or paneer tikka (150 g), 2 roti, sabzi, dal
Before bed (optional)	250 ml milk or a bowl of curd	

Cut or limit:

- Sugary drinks, packaged juices, sweets and bakery items
- Fried snacks (samosa, pakora, chips)
- Alcohol: it slows fat loss and recovery, and adds load on the liver, especially on a cycle
- Very salty food: helps keep blood pressure and water retention in check

Recovery and sleep

- **Sleep 7–9 hours.** This is when muscle actually grows. Same bedtime every night.
- **8,000–10,000 steps a day**, including gym days.
- **Water:** 3–4 litres; more on hot or sweaty days.
- **Sore for more than 3 days, or joints aching?** Take an extra rest day or start the deload early.

Health and safety

> **This plan doesn't include any doses or advice on how to run a cycle.** Steroids and other performance drugs carry real risks to the heart, liver, hormones and mood. In India they are prescription-only. If you go ahead, do it under a doctor (endocrinologist or sports medicine) who knows, and get blood work done.

WHEN	BLOOD TESTS TO ASK YOUR DOCTOR FOR
Before starting	CBC (haemoglobin, haematocrit), lipid profile, liver function (LFT), kidney function (KFT), fasting sugar / HbA1c, thyroid, total and free testosterone, LH, FSH, estradiol, prolactin
About 6 weeks in	CBC, lipid profile, LFT, KFT, estradiol, blood pressure check
6–8 weeks after finishing	Full panel again to confirm hormones and organs are back to normal

- **Blood pressure at home every week.** See a doctor if it's above 140/90 more than once.
- **Stop and get checked straight away** for chest pain, shortness of breath, yellow eyes or skin, dark urine, bad headaches, or big mood changes.
- **Tendons and the elbow:** muscles get stronger faster than tendons, so injury risk goes up. Follow the slow progression and the elbow pain rule.
- **Track** weight and waist weekly, photos every 2 weeks, and how the left elbow feels after each session.

Version 2. Video buttons open a YouTube search for that exercise's form tutorial; pick a short video from a trainer channel (Jeff Nippard, Renaissance Periodization, Athlean-X). Exercise photos: free-exercise-db (public domain). Get clearance from your surgeon or physio before lifting with the left arm, and stop any exercise that causes sharp pain.